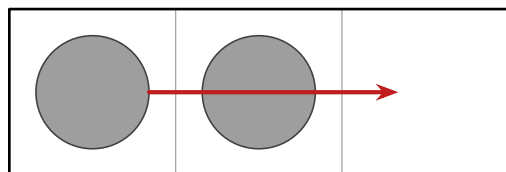


The Hop

The pennies are soldiers. A soldier can **hop over a neighbor** into the empty square right behind it. The soldier that got hopped over **goes home**: take it off the board.

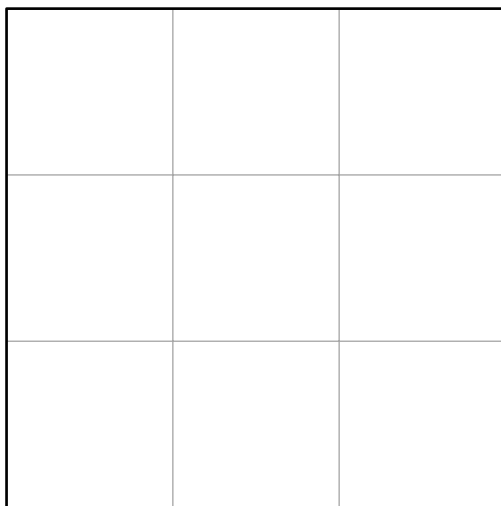


before

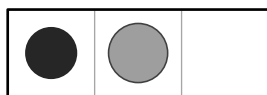


after: one soldier went home

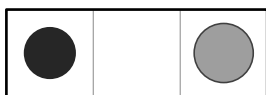
Try it. Put two pennies side by side and hop. Then put them one above the other and hop *up*. Hops can go up, down, left, or right — never slanted.



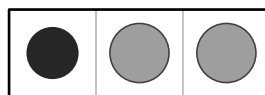
Can the dark soldier hop? Say yes or no.



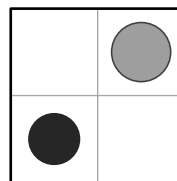
A



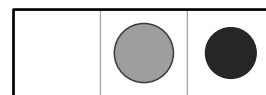
B



C



D

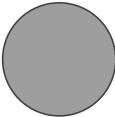
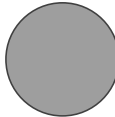


E

Leave One

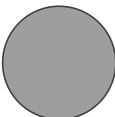
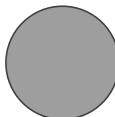
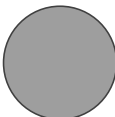
Put a penny on every gray circle. Hop until only **one** soldier is left. Count your hops. If you get stuck, set it up again and try a different hop.

1

				
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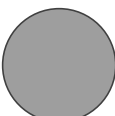
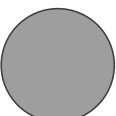
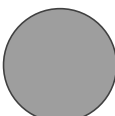
hops: _____

2

				
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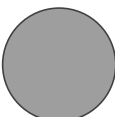
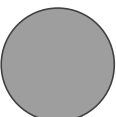
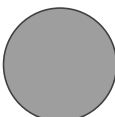
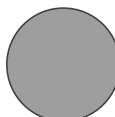
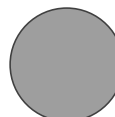
hops: _____

3

				
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hops: _____

4

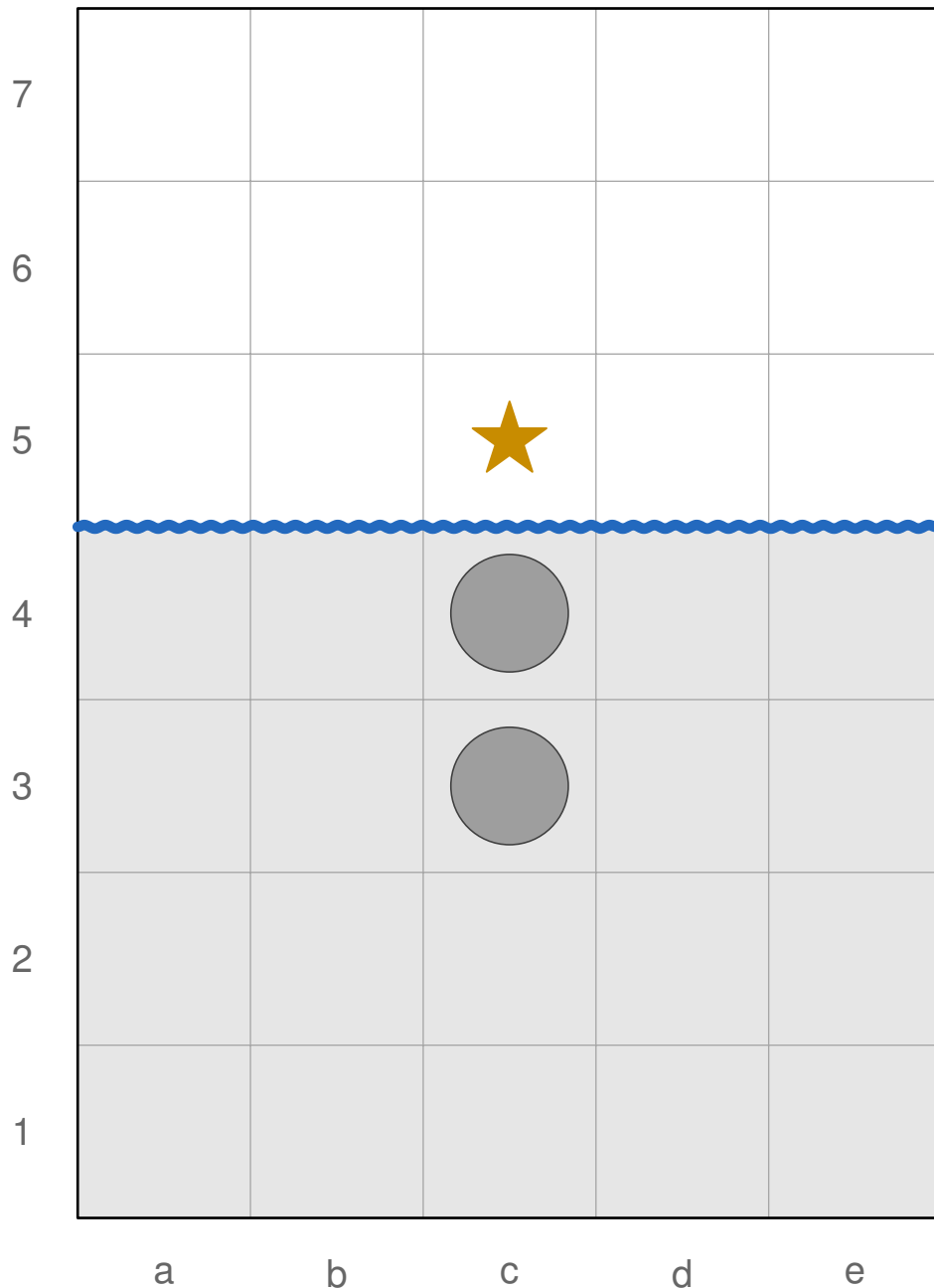
					
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hops: _____

Think: every hop sends exactly one soldier home. The last puzzle starts with 5 soldiers and ends with 1. How many soldiers went home? So how many hops must it take — every time?

Across the River

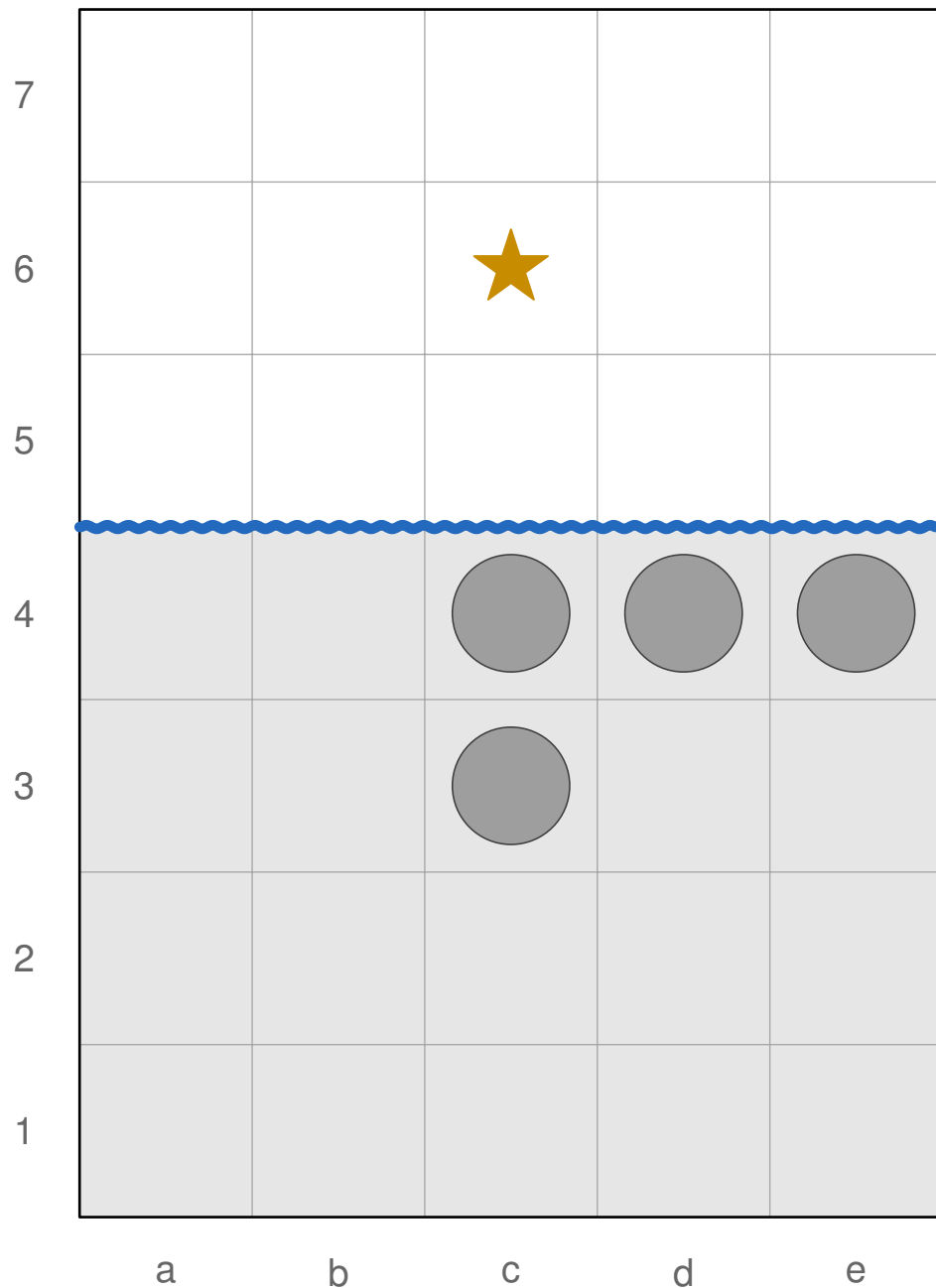
The gray side is the army's camp. The blue line is the river. Put pennies on the gray circles. **Get a soldier across the river**, onto the star.



Then try it again with the two pennies somewhere else in the camp. Where can they start?

Two Rows North

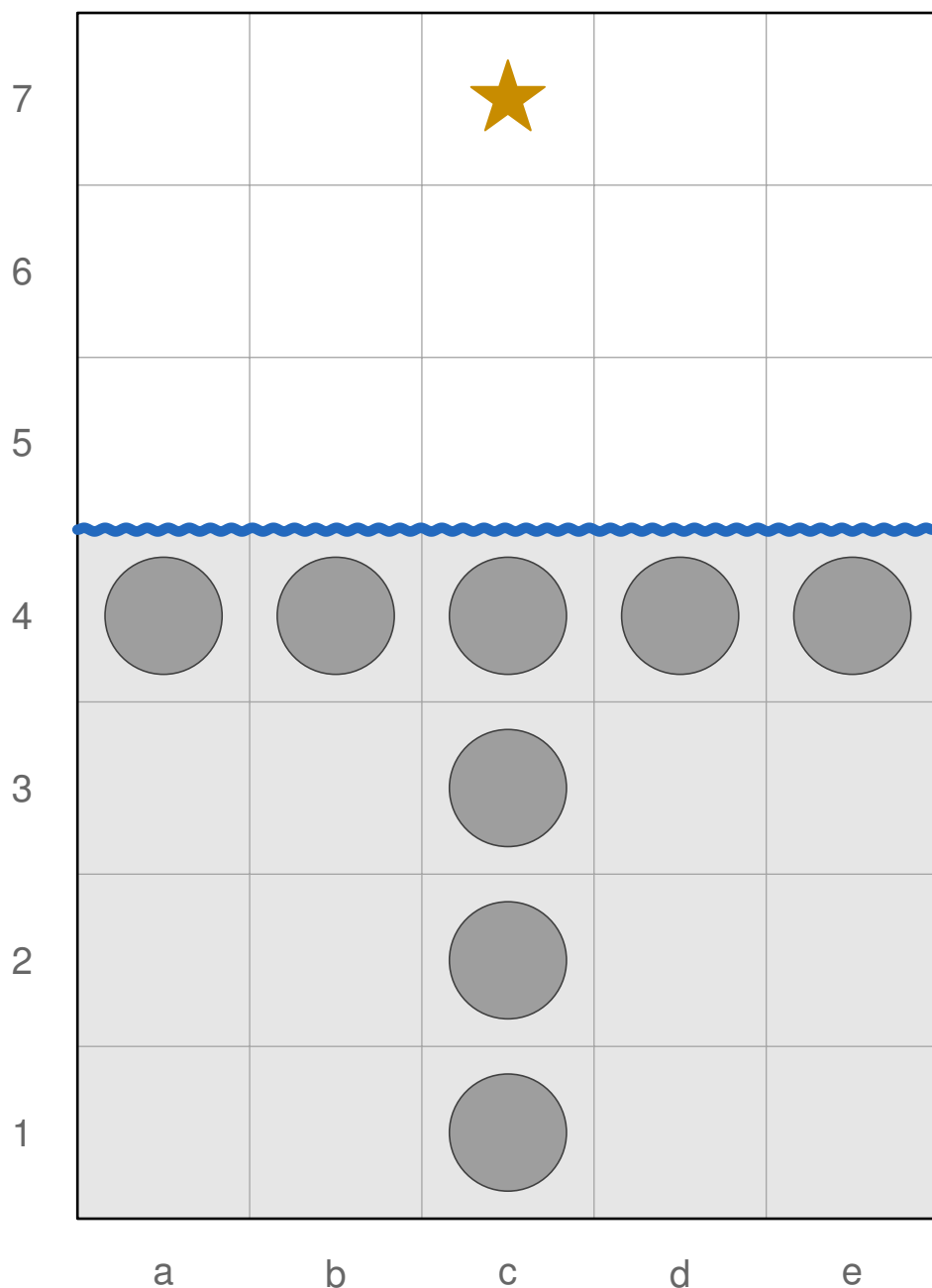
Now the star is two rows past the river. You have four soldiers. Can you get one of them onto the star? Every soldier will be needed.



Did it work? Try it again from the start, and this time say each hop out loud: *up*, *sideways*, *up*.

Three Rows North

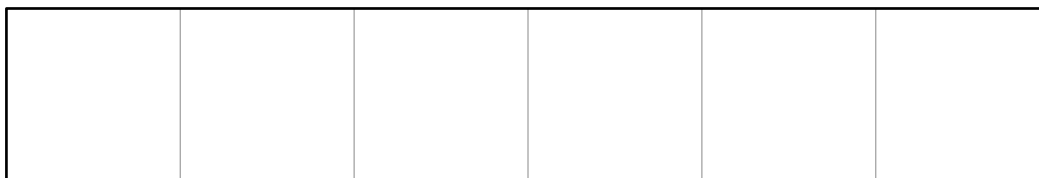
Big challenge, together with your table leader. Eight soldiers stand in a T. Take turns hopping. Can a soldier reach the star, three rows past the river?



Eight soldiers, one reaches the star. How many went home? How many hops was that?

Make Your Own

Put some pennies on the strip — you choose where. Can you leave only one? Then make a puzzle for a friend at your table.



Now a square camp. Put pennies on some squares. Can you leave only one? What is the **fewest** pennies you can leave?

